



Full Screen

The F11 key pertains to the full-screen function. This is one function that the majority of us use quite a lot for its distraction-free attribute and optimising the screen real-estate. There is hardly a consumer lifestyle gadget that doesn't come with a screen or a display, and of late we have even started to see non-screen gadgets sport touchscreen displays – think multi-function printers, routers, refrigerators and so on. The importance of display in the current tech scenario is second to none. In the following pages we take a look at three prime product categories and how the display tech will evolve around them over the coming years

Just 4K-ing around?

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As far as TV display technologies go, we are beginning to see a lot of action in terms of resolutions, smart features on offer and the panel technologies. A quick flashback to last couple of years' Consumer Electronics Show (CES) and IFA drive home the point that the future is about ultra HD 4K technology. But if you go back a few years, 3D TV technology had received the same kind of adulation – we know quite well how that ended. So will the 4K jargon meet the same fate as the infamous 3DTV or is there something more? Let's find out.

TV technology (and in effect monitor technology) has evolved quite a bit over the last decade. We still remember the days when cathode-ray tube (CRT) displays ruled the market and flatscreen LCD technology was just too expensive. That was 10 years ago. Go to any electronics showroom today and all you will see are

flat-screen HDTVs. CRT monitors are still seen around in offices and some homes, but it's not going to be long before their owners upgrade to flatscreen technology. And why not? Cost is not a limiting factor anymore.

In terms of resolutions, we have gone from the standard 480i display on our CRT TVs to HD-ready (720p) flatscreen TVs to full HD TVs. But this evolution cannot be seen in isolation, that would be missing the point.

With the advent of Direct-to-home (DTH) services and Blu-ray technology, the move to full HD resolutions on TV was inevitable. Thanks to digital cable, over the years, we have seen a steady rise in the number of full HD TV channels. Blu-ray drives and players have seen a couple of generations since their inception and although the numbers are not huge, this is the go-to technology for hardcore film buffs who want only the best in image and audio

quality while watching their favourite movies at home.

Alongside higher resolutions, the TV screen sizes have always kept getting bigger. You get LED backlit LCD TVs going all the way from 22-inches to 72-inches and this size surge is sure to forge ahead to even bigger TV sets adorning living rooms.

In case of our humble computer monitors, the move to flatscreen LCD monitors has been more a matter of practicality. The immediate advantage with LCD monitors was saving on space – CRT monitors just took too much desk space away. Graphics cards have supported full HD (1080p) and even higher resolutions for years now, and thus full HD monitors are commonplace for home usage these days. Hardcore gamers, however, don't just stop at 1920x1080p – the maximum monitor resolutions at the moment scale the 2560x1440 pixel mountain. There are enough high-end graphics cards in the